

Fate's Edge

Complete Character Sheets

Core + 13 Specialized Builds

How to Use This Document

Each build includes: a **build guidance page** (tips, progression, key choices) followed by a **character sheet page**. Print double-sided or use separate sheets. All sheets share the same visual language for table consistency.

# Character Creation Walkthrough

Before You Begin: The Philosophy

*“Do not try to build a ‘perfect’ character. Build one who owes a debt, carries a scar, and has a name that someone will remember. The numbers will follow the story—not the other way around.”*

— The Grey Wanderer

Key principles to embrace:

- **Flavor is free** — describe your character however you want; mechanics don’t limit creativity
- **Boons are not XP tokens** — spend them freely; hoarding starves the table of drama
- **Embrace failure** — Partial and Misses make the story interesting
- **You manage your own resources** — track your own Obligation, Fatigue, Boons

## Step 1: Concept Seed (5 minutes)

Start with a simple sentence that answers three questions:

- 1. **Who are you?** (ancestry, origin)
- 2. **What do you do?** (profession, role)
- 3. **What defines you?** (a trait, a debt, a scar)

| Sample Concepts |                                                                                                    |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Concept         | Sentence                                                                                           |
| Duelist         | “A Vhasian exile who lost everything in a duel and now fights to reclaim her name.”                |
| Hedge Witch     | “An Aelaerem village healer who learned magic from her grandmother—and inherited her debts.”       |
| Runekeeper      | “An Aeler tunnel-wright who broke a seal in the deep ways and now serves the Patron who answered.” |
| Rogue           | “A Silkstrand gutter rat who picked the wrong pocket and now owes a crime lord.”                   |

**Sample Build (Kaelen):** *“A Vhasian duelist who lost his family’s charter in a rigged trial. He carries his father’s sword and a vow to restore his house’s name—or die trying.”*

## Step 2: Choose Your Role (5 minutes)

Your primary role determines your primary Attribute.

| The Five Roles    |                    |     |                             |                             |
|-------------------|--------------------|-----|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Role              | Primary<br>tribute | At- | What You Do                 | Example                     |
| Striker (melee)   | Body               |     | Stand in front, deal damage | Fighter, barbarian, duelist |
| Ranger (ranged)   | Wits               |     | Shoot from distance, scout  | Archer, hunter              |
| Face (social)     | Presence           |     | Talk, negotiate, deceive    | Diplomat, courtier          |
| Mage (magic)      | Spirit or Wits     |     | Cast spells, solve problems | Wizard, runekeeper          |
| Support (healing) | Spirit             |     | Heal, protect, aid          | Cleric, healer              |

**Kaelen's choice:** Striker (melee damage) → **Primary Attribute:** Body

Step 3: Set Attributes (5 minutes)

You have **32 XP** to spend on Attributes. Each starts at 1. Cost: **new rating × 3 XP**.

| Recommended Starting Arrays |      |      |        |          |          |
|-----------------------------|------|------|--------|----------|----------|
| Build Type                  | Body | Wits | Spirit | Presence | Total XP |
| Striker (melee)             | 3    | 2    | 1      | 1        | 21       |
| Ranger (archer)             | 2    | 3    | 1      | 1        | 21       |
| Face (social)               | 1    | 2    | 1      | 3        | 21       |
| Mage (spellcaster)          | 1    | 3    | 2      | 1        | 21       |
| Support (healer)            | 1    | 2    | 3      | 1        | 21       |
| Balanced                    | 2    | 2    | 2      | 2        | 24       |

Kaelen's Attributes:

| Attribute | Rating | Cost Calculation  | XP    |
|-----------|--------|-------------------|-------|
| Body      | 3      | 1→2 (6) + 2→3 (9) | 15    |
| Wits      | 2      | 1→2 (6)           | 6     |
| Spirit    | 1      | —                 | 0     |
| Presence  | 1      | —                 | 0     |
| Total     |        |                   | 21 XP |

**Remaining XP:** 32 - 21 = 11 XP

Step 4: Choose Your Skills (5 minutes)

Skills start at 0. Cost: **new level × 2 XP**.

| Skill List by Category |           |             |               |          |
|------------------------|-----------|-------------|---------------|----------|
| Combat                 | Physical  | Social      | Knowledge     | Magic    |
| Melee                  | Athletics | Sway        | Lore          | Arcana   |
| Ranged                 | Stealth   | Command     | Investigation | Ritual   |
| Brawl                  | Endurance | Deception   | Medicine      | Psionics |
| Tactics                | Craft     | Performance |               |          |
|                        | Survival  | Insight     |               |          |

Kaelen's Skills:

| Skill     | Rating | Cost Calculation | XP   |
|-----------|--------|------------------|------|
| Melee     | 1      | 0→1 (2)          | 2    |
| Athletics | 1      | 0→1 (2)          | 2    |
| Endurance | 1      | 0→1 (2)          | 2    |
| Total     |        |                  | 6 XP |

Remaining XP: 11 - 6 = 5 XP

Step 5: Choose Talents (5 minutes)

Talents are special abilities. Costs vary by power level.

| Talent Tiers |         |                                     |
|--------------|---------|-------------------------------------|
| Tier         | XP Cost | Scope                               |
| Minor        | 2-3 XP  | Small situational bonus, once/scene |
| Major        | 4-6 XP  | Strong upgrade, permanent effect    |
| Prestige     | 7-10 XP | Campaign-defining                   |
| Epic         | 11+ XP  | Legendary ability                   |

Kaelen's Talent:

| Talent                     | XP | Effect                                       |
|----------------------------|----|----------------------------------------------|
| Weapon Mastery (longsword) | 5  | +2 dice with longsword, once/scene +1 Effect |

Remaining XP: 5 - 5 = 0 XP

Step 6: Choose a Patron (Optional, 5 minutes)

For non-magical characters, skip this step. For magical characters, choose a Patron.

| Recommended First Patrons |                   |                          |                      |
|---------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|
| Patron                    | Domain            | Best For                 | Obligation Style     |
| The Traveler              | Roads, journeys   | Guides, scouts, couriers | Low, forgiving       |
| Oath of Flame & Light     | Vows, radiance    | Paladins, clerics        | Moderate, smiting    |
| The Witness               | Truth, memory     | Investigators, judges    | Moderate, revelation |
| Ikasha                    | Shadow, secrets   | Rogues, spies            | Moderate, stealth    |
| Inaea                     | Mercy, connection | Healers, guardians       | Low, community       |

Kaelen is non-magical → no Patron.

Step 7: Bonds & Complications (Optional, +XP)

You may take up to **two total** from any mix (e.g., 1 Bond + 1 Complication, or 2 Bonds, or 2 Complications). Each gives **+2 XP**, max **+4 XP**.

**Bonds (+2 XP each):** A mutual relationship with another PC. Once per session, when you act on the Bond with intricate description, **both gain 1 Boon**.

**Complications (+2 XP each):** A burden your character carries. Each unresolved Complication adds **+1 banked Story Beat** to early scenes.

Kaelen’s Choices:

| Type         | Name         | Description                                              |
|--------------|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Bond         | Lyra (rogue) | “She helped me escape the trial that ruined my family.”  |
| Complication | —            | “The magistrate who condemned my family still hunts me.” |

**Bonus XP:** +4 (1 Bond + 1 Complication)

**Starting XP:** 32 + 4 = **36 XP total**

Step 8: Gear & Final Touches (5 minutes)

Starting Gear (assumed free):

- One set of clothing appropriate to your culture
- A melee weapon (Light or Medium) or a ranged weapon with ammunition
- Light armor (or Medium if your concept demands it)
- A backpack, waterskin, 1d6 days of rations, a knife, flint and steel, a small lantern or candle

- Tools for any skill you have at level 1+

### Buying Better Gear (XP costs):

| Item                            | XP     |
|---------------------------------|--------|
| Light weapon (e.g., dagger)     | 4      |
| Medium weapon (e.g., longsword) | 8      |
| Heavy weapon (e.g., greatsword) | 12     |
| Light armor                     | 4      |
| Medium armor                    | 8      |
| Heavy armor                     | 12     |
| Shield (buckler/heater/pavise)  | 4/8/12 |

### Kaelen's Gear (starting, free):

- Longsword (Medium weapon)
- Light armor
- Traveler's clothes
- Backpack, waterskin, rations, knife, flint and steel, lantern

Step 9: Complete the Character Sheet

Kaelen — Completed Sheet

|               |                                                                                                                           |                    |           |  |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|-----------|--|
| Identity      | Name:                                                                                                                     | Kaelen             |           |  |
|               | Heritage:                                                                                                                 | Human (Vhasian)    |           |  |
|               | Background:                                                                                                               | Dispossessed noble |           |  |
|               | Tier / XP:                                                                                                                | I / 36             |           |  |
| Attributes    | Body: 3                                                                                                                   | Wits: 2            | Spirit: 1 |  |
|               |                                                                                                                           | Presence: 1        |           |  |
| Skills        | Melee: 1                                                                                                                  | Athletics: 1       |           |  |
|               | Endurance: 1                                                                                                              |                    |           |  |
| Talents       | Weapon Mastery (longsword) — +2 dice, once/scene<br>+1 Effect                                                             |                    |           |  |
| Resources     | Fatigue: 0 / 3                                                                                                            | Harm: 0 / 3        |           |  |
|               | Boons: 0 / 5                                                                                                              | XP (unspent): 0    |           |  |
| Bonds         | “She helped me escape the trial that ruined my family.” — Lyra                                                            |                    |           |  |
| Complications | “The magistrate who condemned my family still hunts me.” (+1 banked SB)                                                   |                    |           |  |
| Gear          | Longsword (Medium weapon), Light armor, traveler’s clothes, backpack, waterskin, rations, knife, flint and steel, lantern |                    |           |  |
| Combat Stats  | Melee pool: Body 3 + Melee 1 + WM 2 = 6 dice                                                                              |                    |           |  |
|               | Defense DV: Body 3 + Athletics 1 = 4                                                                                      |                    |           |  |
|               | Armor: Light (Harm 1 → Fatigue 1)                                                                                         |                    |           |  |
|               |                                                                                                                           |                    |           |  |

Step 10: Calculate Derived Stats

- **Fatigue Track** = Body rating (**3** for Kaelen)
- **Obligation Capacity** = Spirit + Presence (**2** for Kaelen; not applicable as non-magical)
- **Harm Track** = Always 3 boxes
- **Boon Cap** = Always 5 (trim to 2 at scene end)

## Quick Reference: XP Spending Summary

| XP Costs                        |                       |                                |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------|
| Improvement                     | Cost Formula          | Example                        |
| Attribute                       | new rating $\times$ 3 | Body 1 $\rightarrow$ 3 = 15 XP |
| Skill                           | new level $\times$ 2  | Melee 1 $\rightarrow$ 2 = 4 XP |
| Minor Talent                    | 2-3 XP                | Keen Senses = 2 XP             |
| Major Talent                    | 4-6 XP                | Weapon Mastery = 5 XP          |
| Light weapon (e.g., dagger)     | 4 XP                  | Dagger = 4 XP                  |
| Medium weapon (e.g., longsword) | 8 XP                  | Longsword = 8 XP               |
| Heavy weapon (e.g., greatsword) | 12 XP                 | Greatsword = 12 XP             |
| Light armor                     | 4 XP                  | Leather = 4 XP                 |
| Medium armor                    | 8 XP                  | Chainmail = 8 XP               |
| Heavy armor                     | 12 XP                 | Plate = 12 XP                  |
| Follower                        | Cap <sup>2</sup> XP   | Cap 3 follower = 9 XP          |
| Minor Asset                     | 4 XP                  | Safehouse = 4 XP               |

## Sample Builds at a Glance

| The Duelist (Striker) — 36 XP |                                          |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| <b>Attributes</b>             | Body 3, Wits 2                           |
| <b>Skills</b>                 | Melee 2, Athletics 1, Endurance 1        |
| <b>Talents</b>                | Weapon Mastery (5), Disciplined Body (3) |
| <b>Gear</b>                   | Longsword, light armor                   |

| The Archer (Ranger) — 36 XP |                                           |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>Attributes</b>           | Wits 3, Body 2                            |
| <b>Skills</b>               | Ranged 2, Survival 2, Stealth 1           |
| <b>Talents</b>              | Weapon Mastery (bow) (5), Keen Senses (2) |
| <b>Gear</b>                 | Bow, arrows, light armor                  |

| The Face (Social) — 36 XP |                                         |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>Attributes</b>         | Presence 3, Wits 2                      |
| <b>Skills</b>             | Sway 2, Insight 1, Deception 1          |
| <b>Talents</b>            | Silver Tongue (2), Command Presence (4) |
| <b>Gear</b>               | Dagger (Light weapon), fine clothes     |



**The Runekeeper (Mage) — 36 XP**

|                   |                                     |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>Attributes</b> | Spirit 3, Wits 2                    |
| <b>Skills</b>     | Lore 2, Arcana 1, Insight 1         |
| <b>Talents</b>    | Familiar (2), Codex (4)             |
| <b>Rites</b>      | Road-Sense (4), Traveler's Boon (5) |
| <b>Patron</b>     | The Traveler                        |

**Final Checklist**

Before your first session:

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A one-sentence concept

Attributes assigned (total 21-24 XP typical)

2-3 key skills at level 1-2

1-3 talents (2-10 XP total)

Bonds (0-2, +2 XP each)

Complications (0-2, +2 XP each)

Starting gear (free or XP-purchased)

Fatigue and Harm tracks filled in

Boons at 0/5

Obligation at 0 (if applicable)

A name your character would answer to

**The Grey Wanderer's Last Word**

*"Now close the book. Go make some mistakes. I will be at the inn, buying the wine with a coin that shouldn't exist, waiting to hear what road you choose."*

Your character sheet is not your character. It is a tool to help you tell their story. The numbers will change. The scars will accumulate. The debts will come due.

That is not a problem. That is the game.

**Welcome to Fate's Edge. The road is waiting.**

## Core Character Sheet — Build Guidance

### Core Sheet — First Steps

**Start here.** This sheet works for any character. Fill out Identity, Attributes, Skills, then track resources.

#### Key Choices:

- **Primary Attribute:** Body (melee), Wits (rogue/caster), Spirit (magic), Presence (face)
- **Key Skills:** Choose 2-3 at level 2, rest at 0-1
- **Talents:** 1-3 talents (2-6 XP each)
- **Bonds:** Take 2 bonds with other PCs (+4 XP total)

#### Resource Management:

- **Boons:** Max 5; trim to 2 at scene end. Spend freely!
- **Fatigue:** Each point worsens Position. Full track → Harm+1
- **Obligation:** Track per Patron; Capacity = Spirit + Presence

Core Character Sheet — Page 1

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Talents

Attributes

| Attribute | Rating | Derived                            |
|-----------|--------|------------------------------------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue: <div></div> / <div></div> |
| Wits      |        | Harm: <div></div> / <div>3</div>   |
| Spirit    |        | Obligation Cap: <div></div>        |
| Presence  |        | Boons: <div></div> / <div>5</div>  |

Equipment

Bonds & Strings

Bonds (PCs):

Strings (NPCs):

Skills

| Combat          | Physical      | Social       |
|-----------------|---------------|--------------|
| Melee:          | Athletics:    | Sway:        |
| Ranged:         | Stealth:      | Command:     |
| Brawl:          | Endurance:    | Deception:   |
| Tactics:        | Craft:        | Performance: |
|                 | Survival:     | Insight:     |
| Knowledge Lore: | Magic Arcana: |              |
| Investigation:  | Ritual:       |              |
| Medicine:       | Psionics:     |              |

*“The ledger is never closed. It is only passed to the next keeper.” — Dusana of the Raven Road*

Core Character Sheet — Page 2 (Combat Reference)

Weapons

| Weapon     | Stats |
|------------|-------|
| Primary:   |       |
| Secondary: |       |
| Ranged:    |       |

Armor & Defense

|               |  |
|---------------|--|
| Armor Type:   |  |
| Armor Rating: |  |
| Shield:       |  |
| Defense DV:   |  |

Notes & Goals

| Combat Quick Reference |                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Action                 | Effect                           |
| Attack                 | Melee/ranged vs DV               |
| Defend                 | +1 Position, protect ally        |
| Disengage              | Move without OA                  |
| Charge                 | Move 2 bands + attack, 1 Fatigue |
| Shove                  | Push target 1 band               |
| Grapple                | Restrain, -1 die to target       |
| Aid                    | Spend 1 Boon for +1 die          |

| Armor Conversion Table |        |            |            |
|------------------------|--------|------------|------------|
| Armor                  | Harm 1 | Harm 2     | Harm 3     |
| Light                  | Fat 1  | Harm1+Fat1 | Harm2+Fat1 |
| Medium                 | Fat 1  | Fat 1      | Harm2+Fat1 |
| Heavy                  | Fat 1  | Fat 1      | Fat 2      |

## Melee Combat Specialist — Build Guidance

### The Tank / Striker — Frontline Combat

**Role:** Stand in the shield wall, absorb harm, deal damage. Primary: Body.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Weapon Mastery (5 XP)** – +2 dice with chosen weapon
- **Disciplined Body (3 XP)** – Convert 1 Harm to Fatigue, +1 die unarmed
- **Second Wind (2 XP)** – Clear 1 Fatigue

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I (0-40 XP):** Body 3, Melee 2, Athletics 1. Take Weapon Mastery + Disciplined Body.
- **Tier II (41-90 XP):** Body 4, take Iron Resilience (+2 Harm boxes). Add Shield Bearer if using shield.
- **Tier III (91-150 XP):** Take Sentinel chain (Stand Fast → Unmovable → Shield of the Fallen).

**Tactical Tips:**

- Use Defend action when outnumbered; it improves Position and protects allies.
- Spend Boons on re-rolling failed defense rolls, not offense.
- Taking Harm clears Fatigue — sometimes a small wound is worth the reset.

Melee Combat Specialist — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Combat Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  |           |
|           |        |          | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm     |           |
|           |        |          | / 5*      |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    |           |
|           |        |          | / 5       |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

silience gives +2 Harm boxes

Combat Stats

| Weapon     | Damage / Effect          |
|------------|--------------------------|
| Primary:   |                          |
| Secondary: |                          |
| Armor      | Conversion               |
| Light:     | Harm 1 → Fatigue 1       |
| Medium:    | Harm 2 → Fatigue 1       |
| Heavy:     | Harm 3 → Fatigue 2       |
| Shield     | Effect                   |
| Buckler:   | +1d Defend melee         |
| Heater:    | Convert 1 Harm → Fatigue |

Combat Talents

**Weapon Mastery (5 XP):** +2 dice with chosen weapon. Once/scene, +1 Effect.

**Disciplined Body (3 XP):** +1 die unarmed. Once/scene, convert 1 Harm to Fatigue.

**Shield Bearer (4 XP):** +1 Armor with shield. Protect action.

**Iron Resilience (6 XP):** +2 Harm boxes; survive 0 Harm once/scene.

**Sentinel — Stand Fast (4 XP):** Defensive stance, enemies suffer −1 die to attack you.

Weapon Modifiers

| Weight | Close | Near | Notes             |
|--------|-------|------|-------------------|
| Light  | +2d   | +1d  | Fast, concealable |
| Medium | +1d   | +2d  | Set once/scene    |
| Heavy  | -1d   | +3d  | Set once/scene    |

Cultural Variant: Dhaharan Elephant Rider

**Mahout's Bond (6 XP):** Bond with war elephant; melee reach Near, +1 Armor.

“The tank is the anvil. The striker is the hammer. Know which you are before the drum sounds.” — Master Tarian

## Rogue / Infiltrator — Build Guidance

### The Shadow — Stealth and Subterfuge

**Role:** Infiltrate, steal, strike from darkness. Primary: Wits, Body.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Light Fingers (2 XP)** – First Stealth/Subterfuge roll Position +1
- **The Unlocked Window (2 XP)** – Ignore one security obstacle per session
- **Backstab (6 XP)** – +1 Harm from stealth, ignore 1 Armor

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I:** Wits 3, Stealth 2, Subterfuge 2. Take Light Fingers + Unlocked Window.
- **Tier II:** Add Backstab, then Shadow Dance. Take Crowd Veil.
- **Tier III:** Deathblow (triple Harm from Dominant Position).

**Patron Recommendations:**

- **Ikasha (Shadow):** Shadow Meld, The Unobserved. Best for ghost thieves.
- **Livaea (Social):** Golden Tongue, Velvet Invitation. Best for con artists.
- **Aveh (Fugitive):** Escape Clause, Forgotten Face. Best for runners.



Rogue / Infiltrator — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | / 3       |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | / 5       |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Rogue Talents

Light Fingers (2 XP):

The Unlocked Window (2 XP):

Backstab (6 XP):

Crowd Veil (4 XP):

Shadow Dance (10 XP):

First Stealth/Subterfuge roll Position +1.

Ignore one security obstacle per session.

+1 Harm from Stealth, ignore 1 Armor. On miss, Exposed.

Vanish into crowds. Stealth vs DV 3 to become Hidden.

After Backstab, roll Stealth to re-enter Stealth.

Ikasha's Shadow Arts (Optional)

Shadow Meld (6 XP):

The Unobserved (8 XP):

Step into shadow, emerge from another within Near.

When Hidden, cannot be framed; witnesses -2 dice to recall face.

Tools of the Trade

| Item          | Effect |
|---------------|--------|
| Lockpicks:    |        |
| Poison:       |        |
| Disguise kit: |        |
| Smokebomb:    |        |

Signature Gear

Light Weapon (4 XP):

Throwing Knives (4 XP):

Leather Armor (4 XP):

Silk Rope:

+2d Close, +1d Near. Concealable.

Ranged, Fast tempo.

Harm 1 → Fatigue 1.

“The coin that never spends is the one you don’t remember taking.” — Madam Serafine

## Face / Socialite — Build Guidance

### The Diplomat — Social Combat Specialist

**Role:** Negotiate, deceive, inspire, command. Primary: Presence, Wits.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Silver Tongue (2 XP)** – +1 die to persuasion
- **Command Presence (4 XP)** – +1 die to leadership/intimidation
- **Network Weaver (4 XP)** – Gain minor contact in each new settlement

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I:** Presence 3, Sway 2, Insight 1. Take Silver Tongue + Command Presence.
- **Tier II:** Add Network Weaver, Trusted Reputation. Raise Wits to 3.
- **Tier III:** Spymaster (ask one detailed question about faction movements per session).

**Patron Recommendations:**

- **Livaea (Seduction):** Golden Tongue, Velvet Invitation, The Unrefusable Offer.
- **The Witness (Truth):** Rite of Uncomfortable Question, Echoing Truth.
- **Palinode (Performance):** Hymn Against Dread, The Hooked Chorus.

Face / Socialite — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | / 3       |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | / 5       |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Social Talents

Silver Tongue (2 XP): +1 die to persuasion attempts.

Command Presence (4 XP): +1 die to leadership and intimidation.

Network Weaver (4 XP): Gain a minor contact in each new settlement.

Trusted Reputation (4 XP): Once/session, call in a minor favor from a friendly faction.

Spymaster (8 XP): Once/session, ask one detailed question about faction movements.

Livaea's Social Arts (Optional)

Golden Tongue (Low Rite, 4 XP): +2 dice to Sway for one exchange. Costs 1 Fatigue.

The Velvet Invitation (Low Rite, 4 XP): Automatic entry to any private social function.

The Unrefusable Offer (Standard, 9 XP): Target must accept offer or suffer -2 dice.

Social Combat Reference

| Action      | Effect                               |
|-------------|--------------------------------------|
| Persuade    | Presence + Sway vs DV                |
| Intimidate  | Presence + Command vs DV             |
| Lie         | Presence + Deception vs Insight      |
| Inspire     | Presence + Performance, grant +1 die |
| Read Person | Wits + Insight, detect lies          |

Influence Trackers

Velvet Court Reputation: \_\_\_\_\_

Faction Standing: \_\_\_\_\_

“A smile can open a door that a key cannot. A secret can close it forever.” — Madam Serafine

## Runekeeper — Build Guidance

### The Agent of Covenant — Structured Magic

**Role:** Reliable magic through Patron covenant. Primary: Spirit, Wits.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Familiar (Thiasos) (2 XP)** – Bond to Patron
- **Codex (4 XP)** – Book of Rites
- **Patron's Gift (free)** – Imbue item for +1 die

**First Patron Recommendation: The Traveler** (low Obligation, useful Rites)

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I:** Spirit 3, Lore 2. Take Familiar + Codex + two Low Rites (4-5 XP each).
- **Tier II:** Add Efficient Invocation. Raise Presence for Obligation capacity.
- **Tier III:** Patron's Favor (ignore Obligation cost once/session).

**Obligation Management:**

- Capacity = Spirit + Presence
- Exceeding capacity: 1 Fatigue per segment over
- Clear Obligation via Acts of Service to your Patron

Runekeeper — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track                  |
|-----------|--------|----------|----------------------------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | <div></div> <div>/</div>   |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | <div></div> <div>/ 3</div> |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | <div></div> <div>/ 5</div> |
| Presence  |        | XP       | <div></div>                |

Obligation Tracker

Capacity:

Spirit

+

Presence

=

Current Obligation:

/

Obligation Overflow:

Each segment over Capacity = 1 Fatigue.

Codex & Thiasos

Codex:

Thiasos (Familiar):

Rites Known

Low Rites (Obligation 4-5):

Standard Rites (Obligation 6-8):

High Rites (Obligation 7-8):

Runekeeper Talents

Efficient Invocation (4 XP):

Reduce Obligation of one Low Rite by 1.

Patron's Favor (8 XP):

Once/session, ignore Obligation cost.

Patron's Dedication (4 XP):

Bind to single Patron; sing other Patron's Songs at worse Position.

Sample Build — The Traveler's Runekeeper (36XP)

Attributes:

Spirit 3 (9), Wits 2 (6) — 15 XP

Skills:

Lore 2 (4), Insight 1 (2), Sway 1 (2) — 8 XP

Talents:

Familiar (2), Codex (4) — 6 XP

Rites:

Road-Sense (4), Traveler's Boon (5) — 9 XP

Total:

38 XP (adjust as needed)

"I do not beg. I record. And in the recording, I become the hand that writes the law." — The Grey Wanderer

## Runic Warrior — Build Guidance

### The Spell-Sword — Runes and Steel

**Role:** Frontline caster who writes covenants in flesh and steel. Primary: Body, Spirit.

**Codex Forms:**

- **Flesh Codex (2 XP)** – Rites tattooed on skin. Cannot be stolen. Visible.
- **Stone Codex (2 XP)** – Rites carved on shield/gorget. Can be lost or broken.
- **Steel Codex (2 XP)** – Sentient weapon that speaks. Counts as witness.

**Core Talents:**

- **Flesh Codex (2 XP) + Living Thiasos (3 XP)**
- **Weapon Mastery (5 XP)** – +2 dice with chosen weapon
- **Oath-Bound (4 XP)** – Reroll failed Body roll when serving a sworn oath

**Patron Recommendations for Warriors:**

- **Oath of Flame & Light** – Paladin, smiting, healing
- **Mykkiel** – Law, judgment, binding oaths
- **Grimmir** – Druid, nature, thorns
- **Khemesh** – Warlock, crushing pressure, terror

Runic Warrior — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Combat Rites

Rite of the Kindled Blade (Low, 4 XP):

Rite of the Unbroken Vow (Standard, 7 XP):

Rite of the Sealed Threshold (Standard, 7 XP):

Attributes & Combat Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  |           |
| Wits      |        | Harm     |           |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    |           |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Obligation as Physical Scar

Minor (1-2):

Moderate (3-4):

Significant (5-6):

Critical (7+):

Runic Warrior Talents

Flesh Codex (2 XP):

Living Thiasos (3 XP):

Oath-Bound (4 XP):

Scarred Resilience (3 XP):

Combat Rites

Rite of the Kindled Blade (Low, 4 XP):

Rite of the Unbroken Vow (Standard, 7 XP):

Rite of the Sealed Threshold (Standard, 7 XP):

Cultural Traditions

Ashaan War-Priest (Mykkiel):

Oshiira Gilded Lancer (Traveler):

Pereshi Cataphract (Witness):

Dhahara Elephant-Rider (Grimmir):

Sample Build — Tier I Dawn Warrior (36XP)

Attributes:

Skills:

Talents:

Rites:

Total:

Attributes & Combat Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  |           |
| Wits      |        | Harm     |           |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    |           |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Obligation as Physical Scar

Minor (1-2):

Moderate (3-4):

Significant (5-6):

Critical (7+):

Runic Warrior Talents

Flesh Codex (2 XP):

Living Thiasos (3 XP):

Oath-Bound (4 XP):

Scarred Resilience (3 XP):

“Carve your vows into your flesh. Let your scars be your scripture.” — Master Tarian

## Invoker — Build Guidance

### The Gambler — Power Without Bondage

**Role:** Borrow power from multiple Patrons; versatile but risky. Primary: Wits, Spirit.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Patron's Symbol (4 XP each)** – Physical anchor to a Patron. Max 4 Symbols.
- **Ritual Mastery (4 XP)** – Reduce backlash SB by 1

**Symbol Management:**

- Displaying Symbol reduces DV by 1 and Obligation by 1 (min 0)
- **Crack the Seal:** Resolve Rite instantly; Symbol becomes Compromised, double Obligation
- **Cross-Resonance:** Carrying multiple Symbols creates friction. Limit 4.

**Recommended Patrons for Invokers:**

- **Morag the Hag** – Hidden costs, bargains, Speaking Knot
- **The Confessor** – Burden sharing, confession magic
- **The Ninth** – Hyperknowledge, information overflow
- **Ikasha** – Shadow, stealth, thresholds



Invoker — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track                  |
|-----------|--------|----------|----------------------------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | <div></div> <div>/</div>   |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | <div></div> <div>/ 3</div> |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | <div></div> <div>/ 5</div> |
| Presence  |        | XP       | <div></div>                |

Symbols & Obligation

| Patron | Symbol | Oblig | Status |
|--------|--------|-------|--------|
| 1:     |        |       |        |
| 2:     |        |       |        |
| 3:     |        |       |        |
| 4:     |        |       |        |

Total Obligation:  /  (Spirit + Presence)

Invoker Talents

Borrowed Grace (Free):

Crack Specialist (6 XP):

Symbol Resonance (4 XP):

Ritual Mastery (4 XP):

Spend 1 Boon or 1 Fatigue for +1 die. Mark +1 Obligation.

Reduce Obligation cost of Crack the Seal by 1.

+1 die to ritual roll when using a Symbol.

Reduce backlash SB by 1; first SB each scene becomes your Boon.

Ritual Invocation

Time:

Cost:

Symbol Benefit:

Crack the Seal:

Significant Time (DV in rounds)

Mark Rite's Obligation

If displayed, reduce DV by 1 and Obligation by 1 (min 0)

Resolve instantly. Set Symbol to Compromised, mark double Obligation.

Recommended Invoker Patrons

Morag the Hag:

The Confessor:

The Ninth:

Ikasha:

Speaking Knot, Threefold Exchange, Crossroads Court.

Echo of Sin, Burden Transference, The Cauldron's Secret.

Ninth Figure, Hypercognitive Lattice, The Ninth Revelation.

Touch the Umbral Veil, Umbral Reservoir, Become the Shadow.

“I do not serve. I rent. And when the landlord comes to collect, I had best have the coin ready.” — The Grey Wanderer

## Threadweaver (Free Caster) — Build Guidance

### The Weaver of Raw Magic — Improvisational Casting

**Role:** Improvise spells using the TAGS system. Versatile but risky. Primary: Wits, Spirit.

**TAGS System:** DV = 1 + number of tags. Dangerous tags (Leap, Gate, Transform) add +2 DV.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Spellcraft (6 XP)** – Required for free casting
- **Practiced Caster (2 XP)** – Reduce cantrip DV by 1 (min 1)
- **Controlled Burn (4 XP)** – Convert a 1 into a Boon (GM does not gain SB)

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I:** Wits 3, Arcana 2. Take Spellcraft + Practiced Caster.
- **Tier II:** Add Controlled Burn + Weave Resilience. Choose Elemental Focus.
- **Tier III:** Spell Echo, Resonance Anchor, Elemental Attunement.
- **Tier IV-V:** Weave Harmonist (ignore all SB from one cast per session).

**Backlash Severity:**

- **Minor (1-2 SB):** Fatigue +1, -1 die next roll
- **Major (3-4 SB):** Harm 1, Condition, ward collapse
- **Catastrophic (5+ SB):** Harm 2, permanent Scar, reality fracture

Threadweaver (Free Caster) — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Tier / XP:

| Attributes & Resources |        |          |           |
|------------------------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Attribute              | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
| Body                   |        | Fatigue  | /         |
| Wits                   |        | Harm     | / 3       |
| Spirit                 |        | Boons    | / 5       |
| Presence               |        | XP       |           |

Free Casting — The TAGS System

DV = 1 + number of TAGS (Dangerous: +2 DV)

Casting Roll: Wits + Arcana vs DV. Each 1 = SB for GM.

Backlash (on Miss or GM spending SB):

- Harm 2 (Arcane)
- +2 Fatigue
- Corruption +1
- Catastrophic side effect

| TAG Library Quick Reference |                |          |                      |
|-----------------------------|----------------|----------|----------------------|
| Tag                         | Effect         | Tag      | Effect               |
| Burning                     | Fire, heat     | Freezing | Ice, cold            |
| Storm                       | Lightning      | Stone    | Earth, spikes        |
| Wave                        | Water          | Wind     | Air, gusts           |
| Force                       | Kinetic blast  | Area     | Zone effect          |
| Strike                      | Single target  | Wall     | Barrier              |
| Bind                        | Restrain       | Dispel   | Suppress magic       |
| Veil                        | Conceal        | Scry     | Reveal               |
| HEAL                        | Remove Fatigue | Leap     | Teleport (dangerous) |

Signature Spells

Ember Flick (DV 2): [Burning][Strike] – Ignite small object, 1 Fatigue.

Reed Walk (DV 3): [Wind][Leap][Self] – Leap Far, ignore OAs.

Grasping Roots (DV 3): [Earth][Bind][Area] – Entangle zone.

Shield of Air (DV 3): [Ward][Defend] – +1 Position on defense.

Fate's Needle (DV 5): [Fate][Strike] – Roll 3d10, keep highest for auto-successes.

“Free casting is the mud between the cobbles, the river beneath the bridge. It has no patron to catch you when you fall.” — Lysandra of the Amber Gate

## Cantor — Build Guidance

### The Touched Voice — Song as Power

**Role:** Magic through performance. Corruption is transformation, not punishment. Primary: Presence, Spirit.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Cantor's Path (8 XP)** – Required for songs
- **Steady Voice (2 XP)** – Push by marking Fatigue instead of Corruption (once/scene)
- **Resonant Performance (3 XP)** – +1 die when performing for 5+ audience

**Corruption Clock:** Size = Spirit. Marks when: Pushing a Song, performing Resonant Rite, or GM spends SB on occult activity.

**When Timer Fills:** Gain boon + burden from last Patron. Reset to Tier (min 1).

**Patrons of the Voice:**

- **Palinode (Queen of Encores)** – Performance, rapture, unfinished art
- **Thrysos (King of Revels)** – Drunken Master, ecstasy, frenzy
- **Livaea (Crimson Courtier)** – Seduction, social binding
- **Ikasha (Shadow)** – Whispers, stealth, forgotten songs

Cantor — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  |           |
|           |        |          | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm     |           |
|           |        |          | / 3       |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    |           |
|           |        |          | / 5       |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Corruption Clock

Timer Size = Spirit

1

2

3

4

5

6

Current Corruption: /

When Timer fills: Gain boon + burden from last Patron. Reset to Tier.

Repertoire

Repertoire Timer [6]

1

2

3

4

5

6

At 2: -1 DV to Songs. At 4: +1 die Performance. At 6: Learn one Standard Rite as Song.

Songs & Performance

Sing a Song:

Push It:

1 action, resolves next turn. Roll Lore + Performance vs DV.

Resolve immediately. Mark 1 Fatigue and mark Corruption. GM gains 1 SB.

Cantor Talents

Resonant Performance (3 XP):

Song Weaver (4 XP):

High Cantor (18 XP):

+1 die when performing for 5+ audience.

Combine two compatible Songs for +1 Effect.

Learn Standard Rites as Songs; resolve instantly.

Sample Songs by Patron

Palinode:

Thrysos:

Livaea:

Ikasha:

Hymn Against Dread (allies +2 dice resist Fear).

The Overflowing Cup (allies +1 die social, enemies -1 die).

Golden Tongue (+2 dice to Sway, costs 1 Fatigue).

Cradle Song (lull target, Resist DV 3).

Sample Build — Kestra the Traveler’s Cantor

Attributes:

Skills:

Talents:

Total:

Presence 3, Spirit 2, Wits 2 — 21 XP

Performance 2, Lore 2, Sway 1 — 10 XP

Cantor’s Path (8), Steady Voice (2) — 10 XP

41 XP

“You think you need a lute? My larynx is older than any tree. Hum, and the world will listen.” — The Grey Wanderer

## Witch — Build Guidance

### The Quiet Architect — Threshold Magic

**Role:** Subtle magic through knots, thresholds, and debts. Primary: Wits, Spirit.

**Hedge Gifts (No Roll):**

- **Steady Hand (2 XP):** Remove 1 Fatigue with touch, once/scene
- **Salt Line (2 XP):** Pour salt line; spirits test to cross
- **Hearth-Sense (2 XP):** Ask GM yes/no about threshold or debt

**The Three Layers:**

- **Echo:** Past memory. Work with knots and cords.
- **Veil:** Present boundary. Work with salt and chalk.
- **Flow:** Direction of change. Work with omission and the Ninth.

**Promise Timers:** Track debts and obligations. Size 4 or 6. When full, price comes due.

**Recommended Patrons for Witches:**

- **Morag the Hag** – Hidden costs, bargains
- **Inaea (Angel of the Spider)** – Webs, mercy, connection
- **Ikasha** – Thresholds, shadows, forgotten things
- **Isoka** – Transformation, shedding, venom

Witch — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track                  |
|-----------|--------|----------|----------------------------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | <div></div> <div>/</div>   |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | <div></div> <div>/ 3</div> |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | <div></div> <div>/ 5</div> |
| Presence  |        | XP       | <div></div>                |

Promise Timers

Timer [4]

|   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|

Timer [6]

|   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

Hedge Gifts (No Roll)

Steady Hand:

Warm Hand:

Salt Line:

The Unlit Candle:

Remove 1 Fatigue with touch, once/scene.

Next physical action +1 die (comfort) or -1 die (warning).

Pour salt line; spirits test Spirit+Resolve to cross.

Extinguish light source → dim/dark zone.

Quick Workings (Roll)

Name threshold, choose layer (Echo/Veil/Flow), roll Wits+Lore or Spirit+Insight. Effect: door sticks, candle gutters, pursuer slips.

Witch Patrons

Morag:

Inaea:

Ikasha:

Isoka:

Hidden costs. The Speaking Knot, Threefold Exchange.

Webs of connection. Hearth-Thread Knot, Strand of Inevitability.

Thresholds, shadows. Touch the Umbral Veil.

Transformation, venom. Venomous Benediction, The Shedding.

“The hedge is what keeps the wolves from the flock. I am the one who tends the hedge.” — The Grey Wanderer

## Psion — Build Guidance

### The Isolated Mind — Power Within

**Role:** No Patron, no Symbol, no Codex. Power is internal. Primary: Spirit, Wits.

**Mental Strain:** Capacity = Spirit. Separate from Fatigue. Does not clear when taking Harm.

**Overflow:** When cannot pay Mental Strain:

- Convert to +2 Fatigue, or
- Convert to +1 Harm (Stress)

Exceeding Capacity: +1 Harm, set Mental Strain to max.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Psionics Skill (0-5)** – Gates access to Arts
- **Mental Fortress (8 XP)** – +2 dice resist psychic intrusion
- **Psychic Reservoir (4 XP)** – Store 1 Mental Strain per session (max Spirit)

**The Nine Arts:**

- Telekinesis, Telepathy, Clairvoyance, Biofeedback
- Astral Projection, Psychic Assault, Mind Shield
- Empathic Manipulation, Precognition



Psion — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource      | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|---------------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue       |           |
|           |        |               | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm          |           |
|           |        |               | / 3       |
| Spirit    |        | Mental Strain |           |
|           |        |               | /         |
| Presence  |        | XP            |           |

Mental Strain Tracker

Capacity = Spirit

|   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

When cannot pay:

Overflow:

Convert to +2 Fatigue or +1 Harm (Stress).

Exceed Capacity → +1 Harm, set Mental Strain to max.

The Nine Arts

| Art                   | Key Attribute |
|-----------------------|---------------|
| Telekinesis           | Spirit        |
| Telepathy             | Wits          |
| Clairvoyance          | Wits          |
| Biofeedback           | Spirit        |
| Astral Projection     | Spirit        |
| Psychic Assault       | Spirit        |
| Mind Shield           | Wits          |
| Empathic Manipulation | Presence      |
| Precognition          | Spirit        |

Psionic Talents

Psionics Skill:

Mental Fortress (8 XP):

Psychic Reservoir (4 XP):

Thought Thief (6 XP):

Mind Walker (10 XP):

+2 dice resist psychic intrusion.

Store 1 Mental Strain/session (max Spirit).

+1 die Telepathy; learn one surface thought.

Astral Project without body risk (Mental Strain doubled).

Sample Arts by Difficulty

Surface Thoughts (DV 2):

Telekinesis Light (DV 2):

Biofeedback Minor (DV 2):

Psychic Assault (DV 3):

Read current focus.

Move small objects.

Stabilize wounds.

Deal Mental Harm.

"I carry no Symbol. My ledger is my skull, and it comes due in headaches, not obligations." — The Grey Wanderer

## Monk (Unstruck Bell) — Build Guidance

### The Open Hand — Stillness as Weapon

**Role:** Unarmored martial artist. Redirect, avoid, strike precisely. Primary: Body, Wits.

**Three Principles:**

- **The Coin That Does Not Move:** Never resist what cannot be stopped. Yield.
- **The Witness Who Breathes:** Stillness is the greatest disguise.
- **The Debt That Is Never Incurred:** Do not strike first; create no debt.

**Core Talents:**

- **Unarmed Combatant (4 XP)** – Unarmed strikes Harm 1; grapple bonus
- **Disciplined Body (3 XP)** – +1 die unarmed; convert 1 Harm to Fatigue
- **Still Point (2 XP)** – When not moving, +1 die to next defense
- **Monk's Breath (2 XP)** – Clear 1 Fatigue by meditating 1 minute

**Monastic Traditions:**

- **Way of the Unstruck Bell (Ikasha)** – Shadow Meld, The Unobserved
- **Way of the Iron Vow (Mykkiel)** – Sworn Defender, Unyielding Vow
- **Way of the Endless Cup (Thrysos)** – Stagger Step, Drunken Fist

Monk (Unstruck Bell) — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Monastic Tradition:

Tier / XP:

| Attributes & Resources |        |          |           |
|------------------------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Attribute              | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
| Body                   |        | Fatigue  | /         |
| Wits                   |        | Harm     | / 3       |
| Spirit                 |        | Boons    | / 5       |
| Presence               |        | XP       |           |

Meditation Tracker

The Four Breaths:

Entering → Holding → Releasing → Empty

Meditation Benefits:

Healing: Clear 1 Fatigue, remove minor Condition

Clarity: +1 die next Wits roll

Transcendent: Reroll any failed roll (GM gains 1 SB)

Monk Talents

Unarmed Combatant (4 XP): Harm 1, grapple bonus.

Disciplined Body (3 XP): +1 die unarmed; convert 1 Harm to Fatigue.

Still Point (2 XP): Not moving → +1 die next defense.

Monk's Breath (2 XP): Clear 1 Fatigue, 1 minute meditation.

Flurry of Blows (6 XP): Three unarmed attacks in one action.

Monastic Tradition Techniques

Way of Unstruck Bell: Shadow Meld (step through shadows).

Way of Iron Vow: Sworn Defender (adjacent ally +1 Armor).

Way of Endless Cup: Stagger Step (move 1 band when enemy misses).

Sample Build — Tier I Unstruck Bell Monk (36XP)

Attributes: Body 3 (9), Wits 3 (9), Spirit 2 (6) — 24 XP

Skills: Stealth 2 (4), Melee 1 (2), Meditation 1 (2) — 8 XP

Talents: Unarmed Combatant (4), Disciplined Body (3), Still Point (2), Monk's Breath (2) — 11 XP

Total: 43 XP (adjust as needed)

“The fist is a weapon. The open hand is a promise. Learn both before you need either.” — Brother Tarn

## Summoner — Build Guidance

### The Door-Opener — Binding Spirits

**Role:** Call and bind spirits for aid. Negotiation, not command. Primary: Spirit, Wits.

**Core Talents:**

- **Pact-Whisperer (2 XP)** – Required for summoning
- **Lesser Pactwright (2 XP)** – Summon Cap 1 spirits
- **Greater Pactwright (4 XP)** – Summon Cap 3 spirits
- **Spirit Synergy (4 XP)** – Reduce each summoned spirit's Leash by 1

**Leash Mechanics:**

- **Capacity:** Cap + Spirit segments
- **Ticks when:** Spirit takes Harm, acts against nature, crosses a [WARD], split focus
- **Boon Finesse:** Spend 1 Boon to clear 1 Leash tick (once/round)
- **When full:** Spirit acts once to its nature, then departs (or turns hostile)

**Spirit Types:**

- **Vein-Serpent (Aeler):** Locates ore, stabilizes tunnels
- **Wolf-Ancestor (Ykrul):** Tracks, guards, teaches battle-songs
- **Selkie-Maid (Linn):** Navigation, drowning, retrieving objects
- **Drowned Mutineer (Zakov):** Sabotage, whispers, curses

Summoner — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track                  |
|-----------|--------|----------|----------------------------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | <div></div> <div>/</div>   |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | <div></div> <div>/ 3</div> |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | <div></div> <div>/ 5</div> |
| Presence  |        | XP       | <div></div>                |

Summoning Mechanics

Call (1 action):

Manifest spirit at Near range.

Bind:

Spend 1 Boon or mark 1 Fatigue.

Leash Capacity:

Cap + Spirit =

Current Leash:

/

Boon Finesse:

Spend 1 Boon to clear 1 Leash tick (once/round).

Summoner Talents

Pact-Whisperer (2 XP):

Required for summoning.

Lesser Pactwright (2 XP):

Summon Cap 1 spirits.

Greater Pactwright (4 XP):

Summon Cap 3 spirits.

Spirit Synergy (4 XP):

Reduce each spirit's Leash by 1.

Spirit Link (10 XP):

Spirits act on your turn; commands free.

True Name Keeper (15 XP):

Call any previously encountered spirit.

Bound Spirit

Name:

Type:

Cap:

Special Abilities:

Price/Bargain:

Spirit Whims Table (When Leash Fills)

1: Reveal a secret.

2: Break something.

3: Lead astray.

4: Call for help.

5: Curse a PC.

6: Bargain.

"I asked the drowned captain for directions. He asked for a memory in return. We shook on it." — The Grey Wanderer

## Ranger / Archer — Build Guidance

### The Patient Hunter — Ranged Combat Specialist

**Role:** Fight from distance, track enemies, survive wilderness. Primary: Wits, Body.

**Core Talents:**

- **Weapon Mastery (bows) (5 XP)** – +2 dice with bows
- **Keen Senses (2 XP)** – +1 die perception
- **Pathfinder — Trackless Step (4 XP)** – Leave no trail in natural terrain

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I:** Wits 3, Survival 2, Ranged 2. Take Weapon Mastery + Keen Senses.
- **Tier II:** Add Trackless Step, then Eagle Eye. Take Heightened Senses.
- **Tier III:** The Patient Hunter (+2 dice first attack after observing target).

**Cultural Variants:**

- **Sekogo Throw-Knife Hunter:** Kpinga returns to hand; Spiral Throw hits zone.
- **Ashaan Chariot Archer:** Chariot Volley (two attacks from moving chariot).
- **Fhara Desert Raider:** Furusiyya Training (lance, saber, bow, horsemanship).

Ranger / Archer — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | / 3       |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | / 5       |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Ranger Talents

**Weapon Mastery (bow) (5 XP):** +2 dice with bows.

**Keen Senses (2 XP):** +1 die perception.

**Heightened Senses (3 XP):** Cannot be surprised in natural terrain.

**Pathfinder — Trackless Step (4 XP):** Leave no trail; pursuers -2 dice.

**Pathfinder II — Eagle Eye (6 XP):** Hidden ranged attacks Position +1.

**Called Shot (6 XP):** Blind, Disarm, Hamstring, or Vitals.

Ranged Weapon Modifiers

| Weight | Close      | Near | Far |
|--------|------------|------|-----|
| Light  | Controlled | +1d  | —   |
| Medium | Desperate  | +2d  | +1d |
| Heavy  | Desperate  | +1d  | +3d |

Cultural Archery Techniques

**Sekogo Spiral Throw (6 XP):** Throw kpinga hits all in Near zone.

**Ashaan Chariot Volley (8 XP):** Two attacks from moving chariot.

**Fhara Horse Archery (8 XP):** Fire from horseback without penalty.

**Sidhi Javelin Volley (6 XP):** Throw two javelins as one action.

Sample Build — Tier I Ranger (36XP)

**Attributes:** Wits 3 (9), Body 2 (6), Spirit 2 (6) — 21 XP

**Skills:** Ranged 2 (4), Survival 2 (4), Stealth 1 (2) — 10 XP

**Talents:** Weapon Mastery (5) — 5 XP

**Total:** 36 XP

“The kpinga does not fly. It dances. And the dance always ends with blood.” — Mkara, Sekogo hunter

## Commander / Warlord — Build Guidance

### The Leader — Force Multiplier

**Role:** Direct allies, control battlefields, shape conflicts through strategy. Primary: Presence, Wits.

**Core Talents:**

- **Command Presence (4 XP)** – +1 die leadership/intimidation
- **Inspire (3 XP)** – Give ally +1 Boon and +1 die on next roll
- **Tactical Movement (4 XP)** – Reposition without disengaging

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I:** Presence 3, Command 2, Tactics 1. Take Command Presence + Inspire.
- **Tier II:** Add Tactical Movement, Network Weaver. Acquire Cap 2-3 follower.
- **Tier III:** Battlefield Mastery (when outnumbered, +1 Effect, enemies -1 die).

**Follower Management:**

- **Cap 2-3:** Reliable support, can take independent actions
- **Cap 4-5:** Trusted lieutenants; can manage Assets
- **Loyalty states:** Faithful → Strained → Broken
- **Fitness states:** Ready → Hurt → Down



Commander / Warlord — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track                  |
|-----------|--------|----------|----------------------------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | <div></div> <div>/</div>   |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | <div></div> <div>/ 3</div> |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | <div></div> <div>/ 5</div> |
| Presence  |        | XP       | <div></div>                |

Command Talents

Command Presence (4 XP):

Inspire (3 XP):

Tactical Movement (4 XP):

Network Weaver (4 XP):

Battlefield Mastery (6 XP):

+1 die leadership/intimidation.

Once/scene, grant ally +1 Boon and +1 die.

Reposition without disengaging.

Gain minor contact in each new settlement.

When outnumbered, +1 Effect, enemies -1 die.

Followers

| Name | Cap / Role |
|------|------------|
| 1:   |            |
| 2:   |            |
| 3:   |            |

Loyalty: Faithful /

Strained / Broken

Fitness: Ready / Hurt / Down

Unit Tactics Reference

Aid Action:

Setup:

Rally:

Delegated Upkeep (5 XP):

Spend 1 Boon for +1 die to ally.

Grant ally +1 Position or step up Effect.

Command roll to remove Fear conditions.

Cap 4+ follower manages Assets.

Sample Build — Tier I Commander (36XP)

Attributes:

Skills:

Talents:

Total:

Presence 3 (9), Wits 2 (6), Body 2 (6) — 21 XP

Command 2 (4), Tactics 2 (4), Sway 1 (2) — 10 XP

Command Presence (4), Inspire (3) — 7 XP

38 XP (adjust as needed)

“The elephant does not charge. It walks. And everything in its path becomes mud.” — Rajah Anant, Dhaharan mahout

## Forger / Artificer — Build Guidance

### The Maker — Crafting and Forgery

**Role:** Create, repair, forge documents, build devices. Primary: Wits, Body.

**Forgery Mini-Game (4 Steps):**

1. **Research (Wits+Investigation, DV 2-4):** Learn document specifics
2. **Materials (Wits+Streetwise, DV 3):** Source matching paper, ink, seal
3. **The Craft (Wits+Craft, DV 3-5):** Create the forgery
4. **Presentation (Presence+Deception):** Pass it off

**Core Talents:**

- **Master Tinker (2 XP)** – +1 die Craft repairs
- **The Forger's Eye (4 XP)** – Copy any handwriting, seal, signature
- **Master Artificer (5 XP)** – +1 die Craft creations; reduce time/cost

**Forged Diamond Types:**

- **Cargo Manifest** (legal immunity, one voyage)
- **Notarial Seal** (validates contract, one arbitration)
- **Letter of Credit** (withdraw funds, one use)
- **Identity Papers** (false identity, one scene)
- **Pardon** (commutes minor crime)

Forger / Artificer — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

\_\_\_\_\_

Heritage:

\_\_\_\_\_

Background:

\_\_\_\_\_

Tier / XP:

\_\_\_\_\_ / \_\_\_\_\_

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track    |
|-----------|--------|----------|--------------|
| Body      | _____  | Fatigue  | _____<br>/   |
| Wits      | _____  | Harm     | _____<br>/ 3 |
| Spirit    | _____  | Boons    | _____<br>/ 5 |
| Presence  | _____  | XP       | _____        |

Forgery Tracker

Current Forged Diamonds:

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Laundry Timers:

or [6] — \_\_\_\_\_

Artificer Talents

Master Tinker (2 XP):

+1 die Craft repairs.

The Forger's Eye (4 XP):

Copy handwriting, seals, signatures.

Master Artificer (5 XP):

+1 die Craft creations; reduce time/cost.

Asset Crafter (4 XP):

Reduce Asset XP cost by 1 per tier.

Rapid Construction (4 XP):

Halve Asset construction time.

Workshop Asset

Type:

Minor / Standard / Major

Cost:

4 / 8 / 12 XP

Status:

Flourishing / Stable / Strained / Collapsed

Free Use:

Repair gear, prepare solutions

Surge (1 Boon):

Jury-rig solution, +1 die appropriate roll

Sample Build — Tier I Forger (36XP)

Attributes:

Wits 3 (9), Body 2 (6), Presence 2 (6) — 21 XP

Skills:

Craft 2 (4), Investigation 2 (4), Deception 1 (2) — 10 XP

Talents:

Master Tinker (2), The Forger's Eye (4) — 6 XP

Total:

37 XP

“The right seal is worth more than a ship. A stamped manifest can move contraband past the harbor master.” — Madam Serafine

## Healer — Build Guidance

### The Mender — Restoring Flesh and Spirit

**Role:** Heal wounds, remove conditions, keep party alive. Primary: Spirit, Wits.

#### Healing Harm (Magic):

- Requires [HEAL] + another tag (Purify, Strengthen, Cleanse)
- Base DV = 1 + number of tags. Add +2 DV surcharge for healing Harm
- Example: [HEAL][PURIFY] for poison → DV 3 + 2 = 5

#### Core Talents:

- **Field Dressing (2 XP)** – Stabilize dying ally once/scene
- **Triage (4 XP)** – Remove 1 Fatigue, reduce Harm penalty for scene
- **Knot of Mercy (Hedge Gift, 2 XP)** – Remove a Condition (once/session)

#### Patron Recommendations:

- **Oath of Flame & Light** – Lay on Hands, Cleansing Light
- **Oath of Mercy & Grace** – Healing, forgiveness, spiral of care
- **The Carrion-King** – Fertile Death, transformation through decay
- **Inaea** – Hearth-Thread Knot, shared burden

Healer — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

/

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  |           |
|           |        |          | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm     |           |
|           |        |          | / 3       |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    |           |
|           |        |          | / 5       |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Healing Talents

Field Dressing (2 XP):

Stabilize dying ally once/scene.

Triage (4 XP):

Remove 1 Fatigue, reduce Harm penalty for scene.

Knot of Mercy (2 XP):

Remove a Condition once/session (no roll).

Healing Rites (Oath of Flame & Light)

Lay on Hands (Low, 5 XP):

Cleanse affliction or downgrade Harm by 1.

Cleansing Light (Standard, 8 XP):

Dispel curse, poison, or disease.

Rite of Shared Burden (Standard, 9 XP):

Transfer Condition to willing target.

Healing Reference

Fatigue:

Short rest (1 hour) clears 2; full night clears all.

[HEAL] Cantrip (DV 2):

Remove 1 Fatigue.

Mundane Healing:

1 week rest removes 1 Harm.

Serious Wounds:

Optional rule — lasting debility, needs quest to heal.

Sample Build — Tier I Healer (36XP)

Attributes:

Spirit 3 (9), Wits 2 (6), Presence 2 (6) — 21 XP

Skills:

Medicine 2 (4), Lore 2 (4), Sway 1 (2) — 10 XP

Talents:

Field Dressing (2), Triage (4) — 6 XP

Total:

37 XP

“The [HEAL] tag closes small wounds and eases exhaustion. To knit broken bones, you need greater power—and greater risk.” — The Grey Wanderer

## Velvet Court — Faction Sheet

### The Velvet Court — Silkstrand's Shadow Network

**Reputation Dial:** Enemy (-3) to Creditor-in-Waiting (+3)

**Creditors (The Velvet Seats):**

- Madam Serafine (Information, Forgery, Laundering)
- Old Kes (Fence, Smuggling, Markets)
- The Dockmaster (Movement, Ships, Warehouses)
- Sister Agatha (Cover, Sanctuary, False Identities)
- The Archivist (Legal Precedent, Forged Writs)
- The Grey Eminence (Unknown)

**Heat Dials:**

- **Watch Interest [6]:** Fills when jobs go loud or evidence left. At 3: Patrol Sweep. At 6: Sting Operation.
- **Syndicate Pressure [6]:** Fills when rivals notice. At 3: Curfew. At 6: Crackdown.

**Court Assets:**

- The Blue Ledger (bribeable officials)
- The Maze of Whispers (hidden passages)
- The Ghost Crew (urchin spies, Cap 1)
- The Scribe's Seal (forged notary)

Velvet Court — Faction Tracker

Velvet Court Standing

Velvet Dial: \_\_\_\_\_  
-3 (Enemy) — Hunted; no safe houses  
-2 to -1 — Wary; limited access  
0 to +1 — Neutral; standard access  
+2 to +3 (Trusted) — Attend Velvet Moot; request Favors

Heat Trackers

Watch Interest [6]  

|   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

Syndicate Pressure [6]  

|   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

Creditor Favor Timers

Serafine: [ ][ ]  
[ ][ ][ ]  
Old Kes: [ ][ ]  
[ ][ ][ ]  
Dockmaster: [ ][ ]  
[ ][ ][ ][ ]  
Sister Agatha: [ ][ ][ ][ ]  
[ ]  
Archivist: [ ][ ]  
[ ][ ][ ][ ]

Heist Planner

Heist Clock: [ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ] (6-12)  
Threat Timers:  
Alarm: [ ][ ][ ][ ]  
Security: [ ][ ][ ][ ]  
Inside Trouble: [ ][ ][ ][ ]

Informant Network

| Name  | Reliability [4] |
|-------|-----------------|
| _____ | [ ][ ][ ][ ]    |
| _____ | [ ][ ][ ][ ]    |
| _____ | [ ][ ][ ][ ]    |

Rival Crew

Name: \_\_\_\_\_  
Agenda Timer [6]:  
[ ][ ][ ][ ][ ]  
Goal: \_\_\_\_\_

“The coin you take is never the one that costs you. The one you leave behind—that is the debt that collects.” — Madam Serafine

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*The road is a ledger. Every broken wheel is a debt, every lit lamp a witness.*